THE ARTOMETRICS OF H3

FAST FACTS

3.24B
Total views across all four H3 channels, 2013-2026 — enough to give every person on Earth a nearly half-view

1,638
Videos analyzed after filtering Shorts and zero-view uploads from the original 1,876-video pull

4.5×
How much harder h3h3Productions hits per video vs. the H3 Podcast — 4.78M median vs. 1.05M

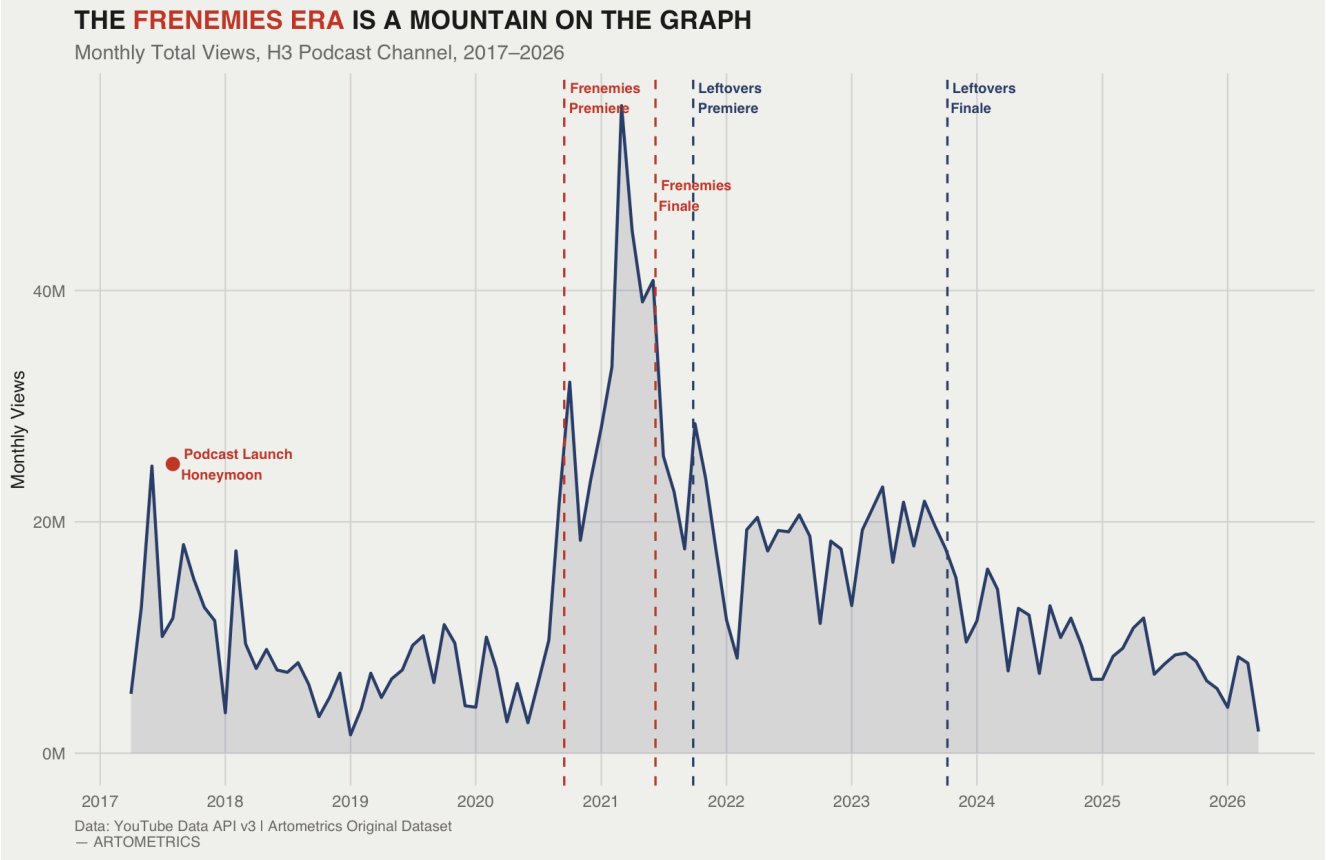
9 months
The entire Frenemies Era — the most-watched stretch in H3 Podcast history, Sep 2020 to Jun 2021

14,487
Wikipedia pageviews for the H3 Podcast article in May 2025 — its all-time single-month peak

88 / 100
"Ethan Klein" Google search interest at the Frenemies Finale in June 2021 — the highest the personal brand ever indexed

CHART 1 — THE ERA TIMELINE

MONTHLY H3 PODCAST VIEWS, 2017–2026



THE MOUNTAIN HAS A NAME — AND IT LASTED NINE MONTHS

Look at the chart and you'll see the architecture of an entire YouTube career compressed into a single slope. The H3 Podcast launched in 2017 with a healthy honeymoon period — celebrity guests, the energy of a new format, a fan base already primed from years of h3h3Productions comedy. Monthly views held in a reasonable range through 2018 and 2019. Then Frenemies happened.

The collaboration between Ethan Klein and Trisha Paytas — two volatile, mutually antagonistic personalities — debuted in September 2020 and immediately did something unusual for a podcast: it grew every week. The format was structured chaos, and audiences couldn't look

away. By early 2021, individual Frenemies episodes were cresting at 4–5 million views apiece, lifting the entire channel's monthly totals to levels it had never seen.

THE FINALE WASN'T AN ENDING — IT WAS A CLIFF

The shape of the drop is just as important as the peak. The Frenemies Finale (June 2021) doesn't taper — it falls. Within two months of that final episode, monthly channel views had roughly halved. The audience that came specifically for Frenemies left specifically when it ended. Ethan spent the following months launching **Leftovers** (September 2021) alongside Hasan Piker, a politically focused show that found its own committed audience but never replicated the mainstream reach of its predecessor.

THE LEFTOVERS ERA TRADED REACH FOR MISSION

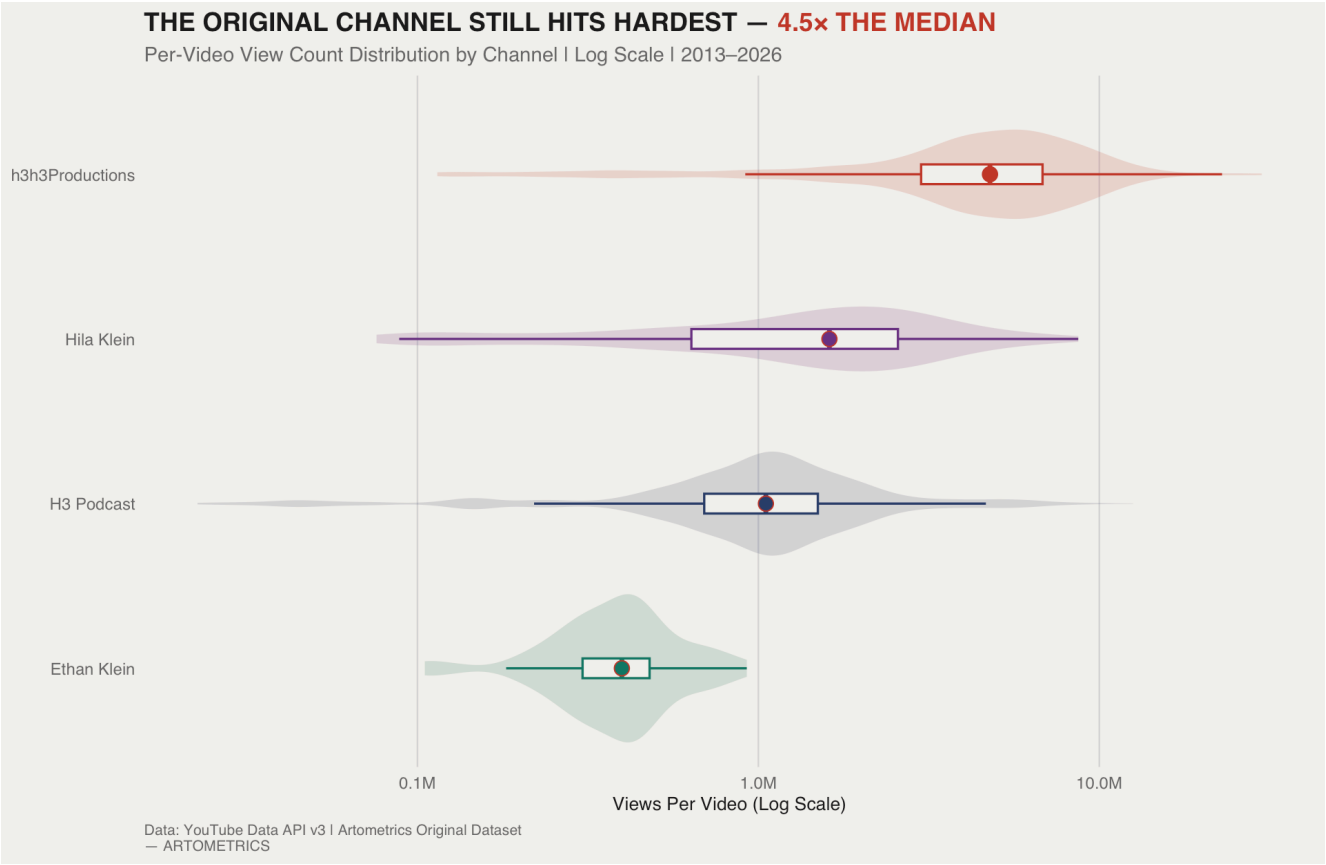
The Leftovers Era (September 2021 through October 2023) reads on the graph as a long plateau at a lower altitude. It wasn't collapse — it was contraction. The show had a sharper political identity, a more defined audience, and a co-host (Hasan Piker, a prominent leftist streamer) who brought his own following. But the casual viewers were gone. What remained was a core audience that cared specifically about the content — which is a different business than what Frenemies had built.

WHAT POST-LEFTOVERS TELLS US

After October 2023, the H3 Show format began its rebuild. The graph doesn't yet show where that trajectory ends — the data snapshot is April 2026, and the channel is mid-recovery. The Post-Leftovers era is the most uncertain on the chart, which makes it the most interesting.

CHART 2 — THE CHANNEL PORTFOLIO

PER-VIDEO VIEW DISTRIBUTION, ALL 4 CHANNELS



H3H3PRODUCTIONS IS A CATALOG — THE PODCAST IS A TREADMILL

The most important number in the H3 data isn't total views — it's the median. **h3h3Productions** has a median of **4.78 million views per video** on 280 videos. The **H3 Podcast** has a median of **1.05 million views per video** on 1,347 videos. The original channel produces four times fewer videos and gets four and a half times the per-video return. That's not a coincidence. It's two fundamentally different content models running on the same brand.

The violin shapes tell the story visually. h3h3Productions has a wide belly at the high end — a lot of videos in the 2–10M range, with a long right tail reaching into the tens and hundreds of millions for the true viral hits. The Podcast's distribution is tighter, higher-volume, clustered around the 1M median with fewer breakout peaks. When you're publishing three to five episodes a week, you don't hit viral on most of them. You don't need to — the model depends on consistency, not explosions.

THE RIGHT TAIL IS WHERE THE ORIGINALS LIVE

The horizontal stretch of the h3h3Productions violin above 10M views is the entire archive of classic H3: the **Vape Nation** (2016) video that launched Ethan as a meme, the Papa John's response video, the fair use lawsuit content that briefly made h3h3 a cause in YouTube's creator-rights debate (2017). Those videos accumulated views for years after publishing. They don't stop — they compound. The Podcast, by design, doesn't work that way. An episode from 2019 doesn't accumulate the way a comedy sketch does.

HILA KLEIN'S CHANNEL PUNCHES ABOVE ITS WEIGHT

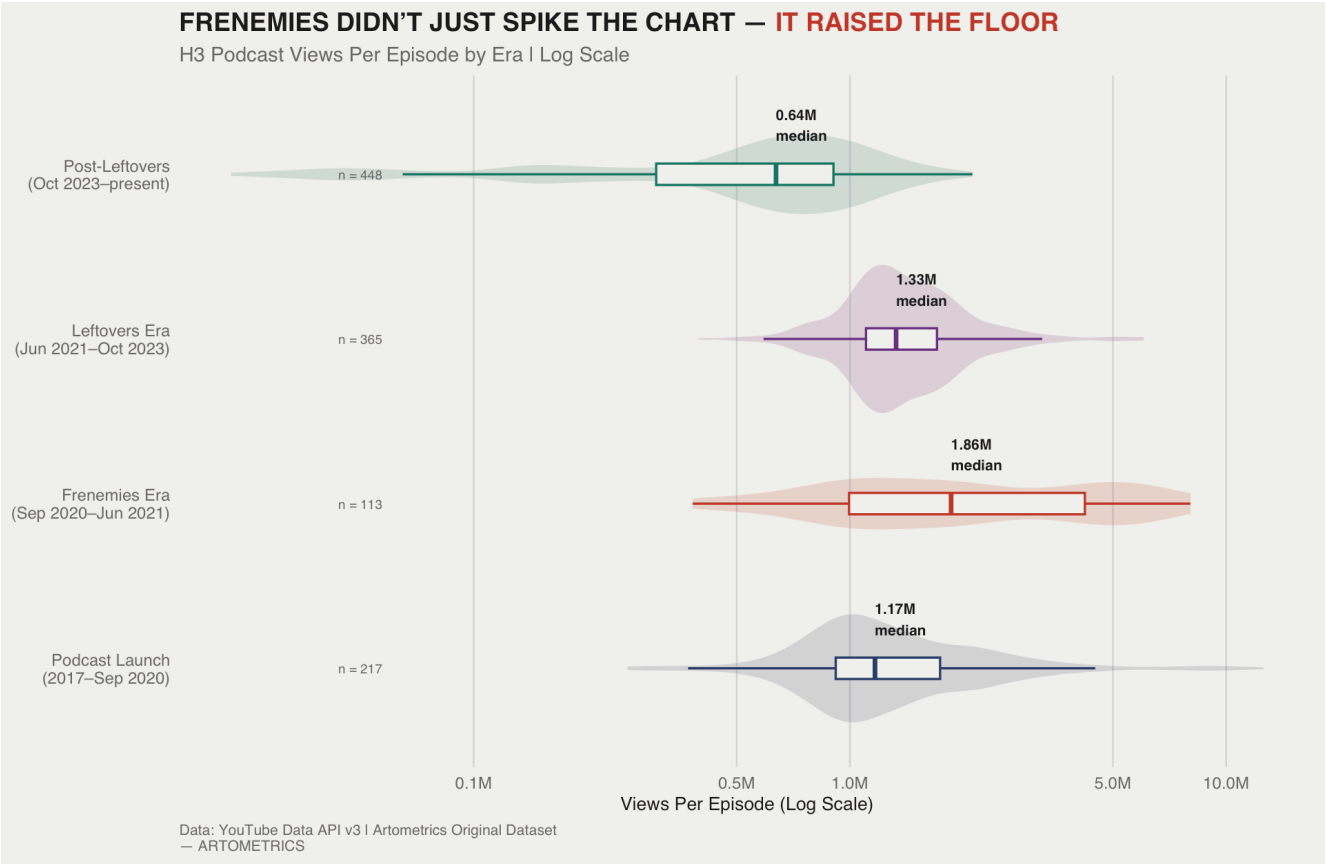
Hila Klein's channel sits at a **1.62 million median** — 54% higher than the Podcast, on just 182 videos. That's efficient. The channel mixes fashion content, vlogs, and Teddy Fresh brand material, and it draws an audience specifically interested in Hila rather than the H3 ensemble. It's the smallest footprint on the chart by video count but comfortably outperforms the Podcast on a per-video basis. In portfolio terms, it's the quiet asset.

ETHAN KLEIN SOLO HAS NOT YET FOUND ITS SHAPE

The **Ethan Klein solo channel** (398K median, 67 videos) sits at the bottom of the distribution. That's partly scale — 67 videos over several years is a low sample — and partly format uncertainty. The channel doesn't yet have the distinct identity that drives repeat traffic and algorithmic recommendation. It's a work in progress, and the data reflects it. The wide spread of the violin suggests inconsistency: some videos are performing at or above H3 Podcast levels, others are barely clearing five figures.

CHART 3 — THE ERA BREAKDOWN

H3 PODCAST PER-VIDEO PERFORMANCE BY ERA



THE FRENEMIES MEDIAN IS THE NUMBER THAT EXPLAINS EVERYTHING

The chart title says it raised the floor — and the medians confirm it. The **Frenemies Era** (September 2020 to June 2021) posts the highest median views per episode in H3 Podcast history. What matters is that the bulk of Frenemies episodes performed well, not just the finale. The interquartile range for that era sits significantly above the others, meaning even the below-average Frenemies episodes were outperforming above-average episodes in other eras. That's a structural lift, not just a few outlier spikes.

THE PODCAST LAUNCH WAS REAL — AND IT DIDN'T LAST

The **Podcast Launch era** (2017 through September 2020) shows healthy per-video performance relative to what came after. The early H3 Podcast benefited from novelty, a fan base already primed by h3h3Productions, and celebrity guests like Post Malone, Bam Margera, and Dr. Phil who each brought their own audiences. But volume increased over time without a proportional growth in viewership — more episodes spread across a largely static audience

means the median drifts down. The launch honeymoon is visible on the chart as a decent starting floor, not a peak.

LEFTOVERS TRADED THE CASUAL VIEWER FOR THE COMMITTED ONE

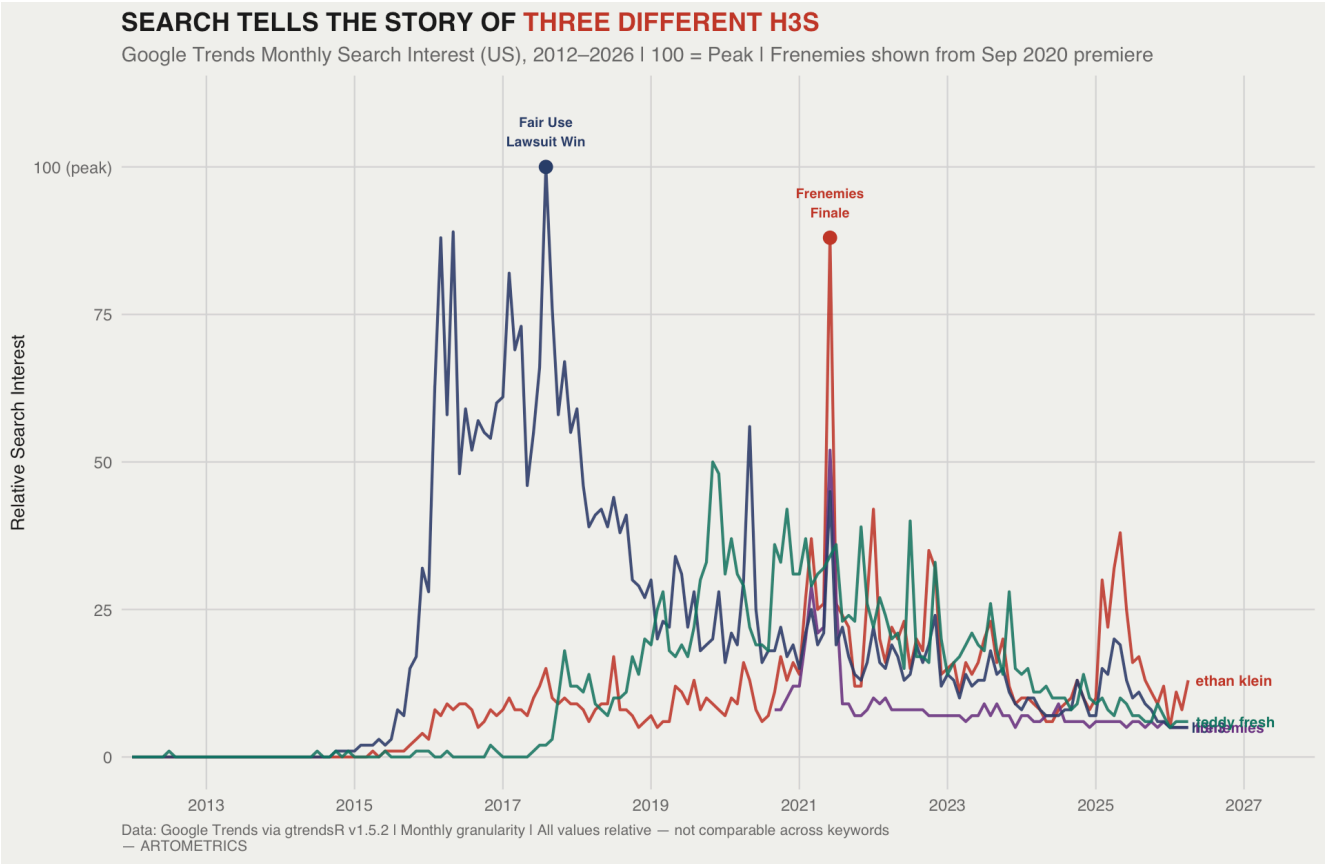
The **Leftovers Era** (June 2021 through October 2023) posts a lower per-episode median than Frenemies. That's the cost of a more politically focused format — you shed the audience that came for drama and retain the one that came for conviction. The distribution also tightens: the Leftovers Era violin is narrower, meaning fewer breakout episodes and fewer complete duds. It's a consistent, if smaller, audience delivering consistent, if smaller, numbers. Hasan Piker brought dedicated viewers. Not enough to match Frenemies, but enough to hold a format together for two years.

POST-LEFTOVERS DATA HAS A BUILT-IN BIAS — AND IT'S STILL INTERESTING

The **Post-Leftovers era** (October 2023 through the data pull in April 2026) has a structural disadvantage in this chart: newer videos haven't had time to accumulate views. An episode from October 2023 has roughly 30 months of accumulation; an episode from March 2026 has six weeks. The median here is therefore understated relative to the other eras, which had years to compound. With that caveat, the Post-Leftovers distribution suggests the H3 Show format is producing some strong individual episodes — the right tail extends further than you'd expect from a channel in rebuild mode. That's the signal worth watching.

CHART 4 — THE SEARCH STORY

GOOGLE TRENDS: FOUR KEYWORDS, ONE BRAND ARC



H3H3 PEAKED IN 2017 — BEFORE "ETHAN KLEIN" EXISTED AS A SEARCH TERM

The **"h3h3"** keyword hits its ceiling in August 2017. That's the month a federal judge ruled in Ethan and Hila's favor in the fair use lawsuit brought by content creator Matt Hoss — a case that had turned h3h3Productions into a symbol for YouTube's creator-rights debate. The channel had millions of fans and a moment of genuine mainstream cultural attention. The search spike is clean and sharp, a single event driving a single peak.

What happens after is the real story. **"h3h3"** declines steadily from 2017 onward, while **"ethan klein"** — a search term that barely registered before 2019 — begins rising. The curves cross somewhere in 2019–2020. By the Frenemies Era, people are searching for a person, not a brand. The channel name stopped being the search entry point. The person did.

FRENEMIES MADE "FRENEMIES" A SEARCH TERM

The **"frenemies"** keyword is essentially flat from 2012 through 2019. The word existed — it predates H3 by decades — but it wasn't being searched in significant volume. Then the H3 Podcast launched the Frenemies show in September 2020, and the search curve lifts off the floor for the first time. By the finale in June 2021, the word has real search interest specifically because of H3. That's a brand doing something a brand rarely does: injecting a word into cultural circulation, not just riding one.

"ETHAN KLEIN" PEAKED AT THE WORST POSSIBLE MOMENT

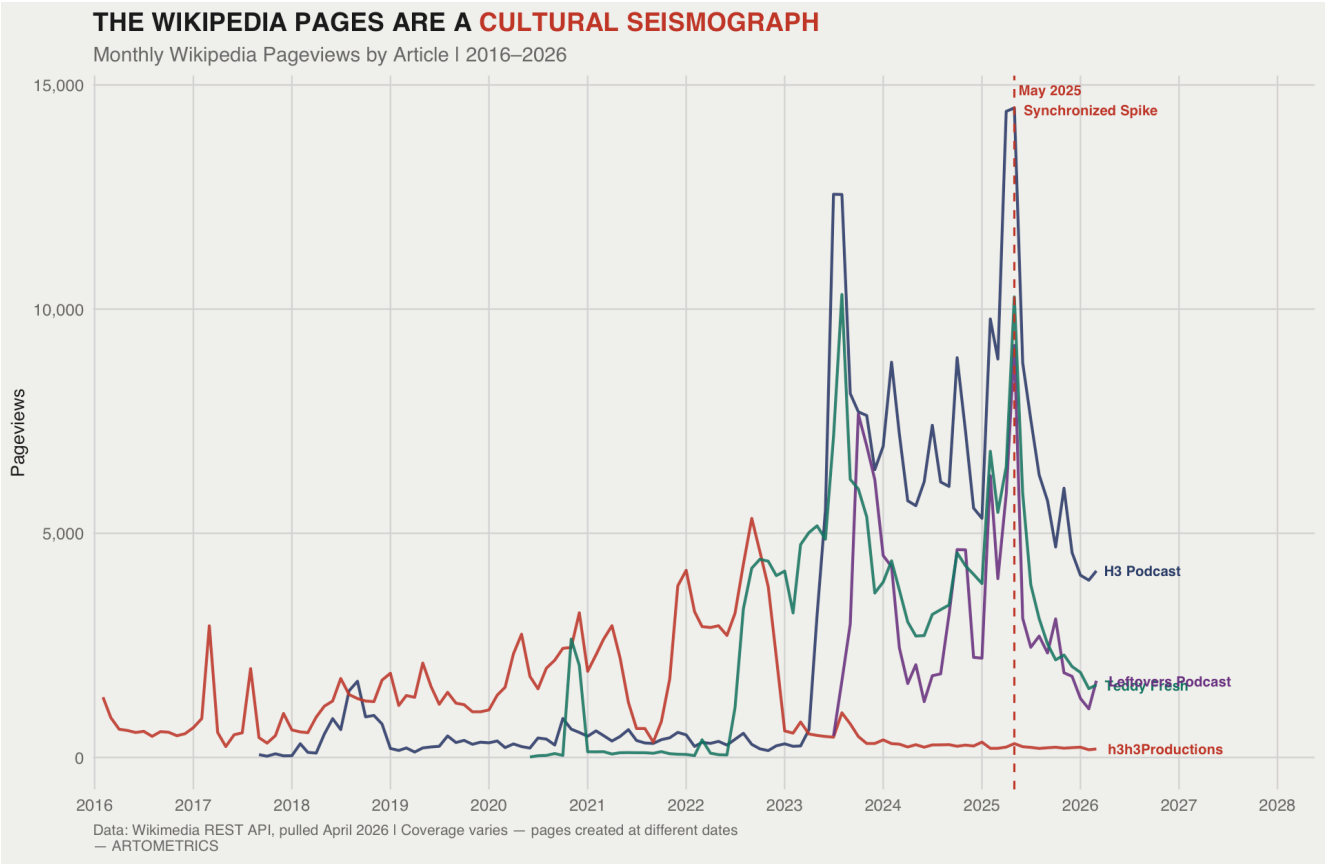
The personal brand peak — **88 out of 100** in June 2021, the Frenemies Finale — came at the exact moment the thing driving it ended. The finale episode was watched by millions, covered by YouTube commentary channels, and generated enormous search activity. Then it was over. The search curve for "ethan klein" has declined since, with intermittent spikes around controversy cycles that are a consistent feature of how H3's audience relationship works.

TEDDY FRESH HOLDS WITHOUT SPIKES

"teddy fresh" peaked in November 2019 (50 out of 100) and has maintained a baseline significantly above zero ever since. That's the behavior of a brand that has built independent search equity — people looking for the clothing line without needing H3 to be in a news cycle to trigger the search. It's the quietest line on the chart and arguably the most stable business signal in the dataset.

CHART 5 — THE CULTURAL FOOTPRINT

WIKIPEDIA MONTHLY PAGEVIEWS, ALL FOUR H3 ARTICLES



THE SYNCHRONIZED SPIKE IS THE MOST INTERESTING DATA POINT IN THE DATASET

In May 2025, the **H3 Podcast** Wikipedia article hit **14,487 pageviews** — its all-time single-month high. In the same month, **Leftovers Podcast** hit **9,189** — also its all-time high. Both peaks occur in the same month, which rules out content-driven traffic. Wikipedia pageviews for podcast articles don't rise because the podcast published a good episode — they rise when the subject appears in news coverage, on other platforms, or in a context that drives people to look them up. Two articles, two all-time highs, same month: something external happened in May 2025.

The chart doesn't tell us what. That's by design — Wikipedia pageview data is a seismograph, not a transcript. It registers when something happened; it doesn't describe what. But the signal is unambiguous.

H3H3PRODUCTIONS HAS THE OLDEST AND MOST STABLE BASELINE

The **h3h3Productions** Wikipedia article has been live since 2016 and shows a long, low-gradient baseline with periodic spikes. The spikes correlate loosely with the channel's news cycles: the fair use lawsuit (2017), the Frenemies collab (2020–2021), and assorted controversy moments that drove outside press coverage. What's notable is the baseline itself — roughly 1,000–3,000 pageviews per month even in quiet periods. That's a channel that has settled into a durable presence in the reference layer of the internet.

LEFTOVERS AND TEDDY FRESH STARTED SMALL AND GREW FAST

The **Leftovers Podcast** Wikipedia page didn't exist until July 2023 — nearly two years after the show launched. Once it was created, traffic grew quickly, which is what happens when a page fills a gap that searchers were already trying to fill. **Teddy Fresh** has its own pattern: steady growth from 2020 onward, with a floor that keeps rising as the brand ages and accrues independent search identity. The clothing line is becoming more Wikipedia-stable than the podcast that built it — which says something about what Hila has actually built.

THE H3 PODCAST PAGE IS THE MOST VOLATILE

The **H3 Podcast** Wikipedia article has the widest swings on the chart. It's the primary Wikipedia entry point for the H3 universe — the page people land on when they search "H3 Podcast" and click the encyclopedia result. That makes it sensitive to external events in a way the other pages aren't. When H3 is in the news, this page absorbs the traffic. The May 2025 spike is the starkest expression of that dynamic in the dataset.

LIMITATIONS

THE VIEW COUNT SNAPSHOT PROBLEM

Every view count in this dataset was pulled in **April 2026** via the YouTube Data API v3. That means older videos have had more time to accumulate views than newer ones. The result is a structural bias across every chart: videos from 2017 look more successful relative to videos

from 2025, partly because they've had eight additional years of algorithmic recommendation and social sharing. This is most visible in the **Post-Leftovers era** analysis (Chart 3), where recent episodes appear to underperform earlier eras — some of that gap is real, and some of it is accumulation time. There is no correction for this; it's a known limitation of a single-point API pull.

PRIVATE AND DELETED VIDEOS ARE INVISIBLE

The YouTube Data API v3 only returns public, available videos. **Private, members-only, and deleted videos are not in this dataset.** H3 has published a meaningful volume of Patreon/membership content over the years, and some early h3h3Productions videos have been removed (either by the channel or by platform action). The dataset captures the public archive only — not the full production history.

GOOGLE TRENDS VALUES ARE RELATIVE, NOT ABSOLUTE

Every Trends value in this analysis is indexed to the peak within the pull window, not to any absolute measure of search volume. **100 for "h3h3"** and **88 for "ethan klein"** are not comparable to each other — they're each the maximum within their own series. A term with 50 relative interest could represent ten times the raw search volume of a term with 80 relative interest on a separate pull. The trends data shows shape and timing, not magnitude comparisons across keywords.

WIKIPEDIA COVERAGE STARTS AT DIFFERENT DATES

The four Wikipedia articles in this dataset were created at very different times: h3h3Productions (2016), H3 Podcast (2017), Teddy Fresh (2020), Leftovers Podcast (2023). Comparisons across articles in periods where some didn't exist are not valid. The Leftovers Podcast page has less than three years of data. Any conclusion about relative cultural footprint needs to account for page age.

CONCLUSION

ONE BRAND, FOUR DIFFERENT BUSINESSES

The H3 data tells a story that most platform analytics obscure: **Ethan and Hila Klein aren't running one business, they're running four**. h3h3Productions is a catalog — a finite archive of high-performing comedy content that keeps earning views without new investment. The H3 Podcast is a volume operation — an enormous library built on consistency, with peaks tied to specific eras rather than specific videos. Hila Klein's channel is a focused brand platform, quiet and efficient. The Ethan Klein solo channel is a bet on a format that hasn't fully materialized yet.

The aggregate 3.24 billion views obscures which channel is doing what work. Once you separate the distributions, the strategic reality becomes clearer: h3h3Productions earns 4.5 times more per video than the Podcast, on one-fifth the output. The original channel is the most capital-efficient asset in the portfolio. The Podcast is the cultural heartbeat — high output, lower per-unit return, but the thing that keeps the brand alive in the weekly conversation.

FRENEMIES WAS BOTH A CEILING AND A CASE STUDY

Nine months. The entire Frenemies Era fits inside the gestation period of a human pregnancy, and it produced the highest per-episode views in H3 Podcast history. What made it work — two personalities with genuine friction, an audience that couldn't predict the outcome, a format that escalated — is also what made it irreproducible. You can't engineer the conditions that made Frenemies Frenemies. You can only recognize, after the fact, what combination of factors created the mountain on the graph.

The post-Frenemies data — the decline, the Leftovers pivot, the current rebuild — is actually the more useful case study. It shows what happens when a platform business loses its defining product and has to rebuild identity without it. The search curves, the Wikipedia baselines, the Post-Leftovers per-video distribution: these aren't collapse signals. They're recalibration signals. The floor is lower than 2021. It hasn't disappeared.

THE CULTURAL SIGNAL OUTLASTS THE CONTENT

The Wikipedia seismograph and the Google Trends crossovers are both saying the same thing: **the H3 brand has become legible beyond YouTube**. When the h3h3Productions article sustains 2,000 monthly Wikipedia pageviews in a quiet month, that's not fans looking up the channel — that's the broader internet using Wikipedia as a reference layer for a cultural entity that has earned a durable entry in the public record. That's not guaranteed for YouTube channels. Most don't get there.

The May 2025 synchronized spike across two Wikipedia articles is the most recent evidence that whatever happens next with H3, the infrastructure of cultural relevance is intact.

— KSM

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EDITOR'S NOTE

This report was researched, written, designed, and produced in active collaboration with Claude AI (Anthropic). The data pipeline, statistical analysis, chart design, written analysis, narrative structure, and visual styling were all developed through a directed partnership between human editorial judgment and AI execution.

Artometrics was built on the premise that rigorous analysis and honest process are not in conflict. The research questions, editorial instincts, interpretive framing, and brand vision are ours. The execution — every line of R code, every paragraph of analysis, every design decision — was a collaboration. We document this not as a disclaimer but as a description of how we actually work, and as a position: we believe this is what serious data journalism looks like when the tools available are used honestly and at full capacity.

— Artometrics Editorial

ARTOMETRICS